Drift Atlas

PEER USER TEST - NOVEMBER 5, 2026

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Drift Atlas is a place-based way to explore historical NOAA surface-drifter observations. It lets a visitor find instruments that passed near a chosen point in 2024, then follow one visible regional record before and after that encounter.

Four things to try

01 Before using the controls, explain whether the website is showing live ocean movement, a forecast, or historical observations.

02 Choose a location, month, and search radius different from the opening example. How many drifters does the archive return?

03 Open one result and follow its 2024 record. When did it come near your selected place, and what general direction did it travel afterward?

04 Find one warning about the limits of the data. What should you avoid concluding from a single route or an empty search?

Please note where you hesitate, what you expected to happen, and any label that did not make sense. The test is about the project, not the tester.